

Basketball - Understanding Your Coach

Name: _____

Date: _____

False friend: "basket"

1. Pre-teach: 20 words you'll actually hear from a coach

From this video (10) - the rules:

#	Word / phrase	Meaning
1	traveling	carrying the ball for more than two steps without dribbling
2	double dribble	stopping your dribble, then starting to dribble again
3	foul	illegal contact with a player who has the ball
4	turnover	losing possession of the ball to the other team
5	possession	which team currently controls the ball
6	sideline / out of bounds	the line marking the edge of the court – step over it with the ball and you lose possession
7	layup	a moving shot taken very close to the basket, while still moving toward it
8	jump shot	a shot taken after dribbling and stopping – can be from anywhere on the court
9	rebound	gaining possession of the ball after a missed shot
10	dribble	bouncing the ball continuously with one hand while moving

General coaching vocabulary (10) - for the actual on-court lesson:

#	Word / phrase	Meaning
11	pass	throwing the ball to a teammate
12	shoot	attempting to score
13	defense	trying to stop the other team scoring
14	offense	trying to score
15	hoop / net	the raised ring and net you shoot into (never "basket" on its own – see above)

#	Word / phrase	Meaning
16	pivot	keeping one foot planted and turning on it while holding the ball
17	block	stopping an opponent's shot by touching the ball
18	assist	a pass that directly leads to a teammate scoring
19	free throw	an unopposed shot awarded after certain fouls
20	court	the marked playing area

2. Reading (5-7 min)

Basketball has a few core rules that come up in almost every game. The first is traveling – if you're holding the ball and take more than two steps without dribbling, the other team gets the ball. The second is double dribble: once you stop dribbling and hold the ball, you can't start dribbling again. Step outside the lines of the court while you have the ball, and that's out of bounds – another way to lose possession. Contact with an opponent who has the ball is a foul. As for scoring, there are two main shots: a layup, taken right next to the basket while you're still moving, and a jump shot, taken after you've stopped, which can be from anywhere on the court. If a shot misses and you grab the ball back, that's called a rebound.

Comprehension questions: 1. What's the difference between traveling and double dribble? 2. What happens if a player steps out of bounds while holding the ball? 3. What's the key difference between a layup and a jump shot? 4. What is a rebound?

3. Writing (5-7 min)

Choose one: - **A.** Write 5 sentences explaining the rules of basketball to someone who has never seen a game, using at least 5 words from the list above. - **B.** Write a short paragraph (6–8 sentences) describing an imaginary basketball match, using at least 6 words from the list – include at least one rule violation (traveling, double dribble, foul, or out of bounds).

4. Oral comprehension – video task (8-10 min)

The video is dense, so two viewings work well here.

First listen – gist. While watching, students note down every rule mentioned, in order (there are 7). Compare in pairs.

Second listen - gap-fill. Hand out these lines with blanks; students fill in as they watch again.

1. "The first but most important rule of basketball is ____."
2. "Double dribbling is when you're dribbling and you pick the ball up and start ____ again."
3. "A foul is when someone's got the ball and another player makes ____ with them."
4. "A layup is a type of moving shot when you move to the basket and ____ at the same time."
5. "A jump shot is when you dribble towards the hoop, stop, then take a ____."
6. "A rebound is when a player gains possession after a ____ shot."

True/false check: - A layup can be taken from anywhere on the court. - Traveling means taking more than two steps while carrying the ball without dribbling. - A rebound happens after a successful shot.

5. Oral expression: imperative vs diplomatic register

Since this video explains rules rather than giving live commands, this table uses general basketball coaching language instead – still the register your students will actually hear on court. Items marked are for B1-B2 students.

Imperative (everyone)	Diplomatic (B1-B2)
Pass the ball.	Could you pass it over here, please?
Dribble with your other hand.	Would you try dribbling with your other hand?
Get back on defense.	Could you get back and help on defense?
Shoot!	Would you like to take the shot?
Watch your feet.	Could you be careful with your footwork, please?
Box out.	Would you mind boxing out under the basket?
Call for the ball.	Could you call out if you're free?
Set a screen.	Would you set a screen for me here?
Switch!	Could we switch defenders, please?
Try again.	Shall we run that one again?

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Video

Basketball Rules Explained – <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=1JZCQ2iqSm4> (channel: Young Ballerz Basketball) Presented by a young English player, Thomas, explaining the core rules in under 2 minutes. Genuinely useful register: quick, a little informal, with natural self-corrections ("this will cause the... to for the other team to have the ball") – good authentic listening, but dense (7 rules in ~100 seconds), so plan for at least two viewings. This one's about **rules**, not live coaching commands like the horse riding/tennis videos – so the vocabulary and reading sections below lean more on rule vocabulary, and I've built the coaching-command register table from general basketball coaching language instead (section 5).

6. Game / role-play (10 min)

"Ref Call" (new, built around this video's actual content) - One student mimes a basketball action or violation (walking with the ball without dribbling = travel; stopping the dribble, holding, then dribbling again = double dribble; bumping another player = foul; stepping over a taped/marked line = out of bounds; a clean pass or shot = no call). - The rest of the group are "referees" – first to correctly shout the right call (or "no call!") gets a point. Directly recycles the rule vocabulary from the video.

Alternative - "Coach Says" (same format as horse riding and tennis, for consistency) - One student is the coach, the rest mime the actions. Commands only followed if preceded by "*Coach says...*" Use the diplomatic versions as a twist for B1-B2 students.

All three sports now follow the same six-part shape. Let me know if you want a one-page overview comparing all three, or if there's a fourth activity (dance, "act") worth the same treatment.

About this activity

Same structure as horse riding and tennis – all four skills, one theme ~45–50 min total, can be split across two sessions

False friend: "basket"

Worth flagging explicitly, since it's a very common French-English slip: in French, *le basket* can casually mean the whole sport. **In English, you never shorten "basketball" to "basket."** You play **basketball**, not "basket." "A basket" in English does exist, but it means a *successful shot* – "he scored a great basket" – or, informally, the hoop/net itself. Worth putting on the board before anything else.

1. Pre-teach: 20 words you'll actually hear from a coach

Matching worksheet – paste into the Daily Vocabulary Generator (Day 1 matching / Day 2 test) or use as-is.

2. Reading (5-7 min)

Short text – hand out or project. Ask comprehension questions after (below).

4. Oral comprehension - video task (8-10 min)

1. 1. traveling 2. dribbling 3. contact 4. shoot 5. shot 6. missed
2. A layup can be taken from anywhere on the court. → False – that's a jump shot; a layup has to be close to the basket
3. Traveling means taking more than two steps while carrying the ball without dribbling. → True
4. A rebound happens after a successful shot. → False – after a missed shot